Production Release Management Process

Document Owner: Platform Engineering
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1. Purpose

This process describes how the Platform Engineering team releases changes to production services.

2. Scope

Applies to all application deployments to the production environment.

3. Release Authorisation

3.1 Production releases require authorisation by a release manager who did not implement the change.

3.2 The release manager records their approval in the deployment ticket before the release pipeline is triggered.

4. Pre-Release Verification

4.1 All changes are deployed to the staging environment and verified by the implementing engineer before a production release is scheduled.

4.2 The engineer confirms that a rollback approach exists before deploying. Rollback steps are discussed during the release call.

5. Emergency Releases

5.1 Emergency releases may be deployed immediately at the discretion of the on-call engineer.

6. Related Documents

Detailed approval thresholds are defined in SOP OPS-174.